Fall 2024

CESAR CHAVEZ ACADEMIC NEWSLETTER



CESAR CHAVEZ
HIGH SCHOOL

Principal's Corner

ROBERT GRANT

Welcome to our first edition of our academic quarterly newsletter! We are excited to share this new platform with you, designed to highlight the incredible work our staff is doing to improve the academic performance of our champions. This newsletter will help parents and families stay informed about key developments in our academic programs and improvement initiatives.

As we kick off this newsletter, I want to emphasize the critical role attendance plays in student success. We have noticed a concerning trend in our first-period attendance, with high rates of absences and tardies. We understand that starting the day at 7:30 AM can be challenging, but arriving on time is crucial for academic achievement. Data shows a direct correlation between consistent attendance and student performance. Once a student reaches 12 absences, they may risk not earning credit in their classes, which can have long-term implications for their education. Together, let's encourage our students to attend school regularly and on time, setting them up for academic success.

Thank you for your continued support, and we look forward to celebrating the achievements of our Chavez champions in future newsletters!







Schoolwide Academic Improvement Goals

This school year, we've set four primary goals to guide our efforts in supporting student success:

1. **Enhance English Language Arts Proficiency:** We're focused on increasing our ACT English and Reading scores and improving literacy instruction across all content areas.
2. **Strengthen Math Interventions:** Our goal is to refine our math interventions by including strategic retakes, utilizing Edmentum (online platform -see below) during Advisory and Learning and Development Days.
3. **Boost ACT Performance:** We're implementing targeted practice sessions in Advisory and on select Saturdays to help students become more confident with the ACT format and content.
4. **Elevate Teaching Practices:** We're committed to improving lesson planning, encouraging instructional risk-taking, and increasing rigor and enrichment opportunities for students through strategic practices embedded in our collaborative teams.

We're thrilled to share the progress we've made so far! A significant number of teachers participated in training on creative instructional strategies during the first quarter that offer students more choice and aim to increase engagement. We've implemented school-wide literacy strategies like "Marking the Text" and "Finding the Main Idea," which students can apply in all subjects. Additionally, we've launched an ACT Prep Committee, an Academic Celebration Committee, and trained our staff on using Edmentum (see below) to support our math intervention goals. Our momentum is strong, and we're excited to continue this journey of growth and achievement!

WHAT IS EDMENTUM?

Edmentum is an online learning platform that provides personalized educational resources and courses tailored to meet the individual needs of students. It aligns with your child's NWEA scores by using these assessment results to create customized learning paths that target specific skill gaps and areas for improvement. This personalized approach helps ensure that each student receives the right support to enhance their understanding of key concepts. By utilizing Edmentum, students can build on their strengths and work through challenges at their own pace, reinforcing their learning and growth throughout the school year. **On future Learning & Development (L&D) days, all students will be required to log into Edmentum and earn a trophy by completing a math lesson to be counted for attendance.**

> We encourage each other to experiment with new ideas in our Junior English team. Any time someone pitches an idea, everyone adds useful suggestions and provides resources. We are never competitive. Instead, We are generous with each other and share every possible resource. It is a judgement free zone. This allows us to unpack failures, missed goals, bad lessons, etc. in order to learn and grow.
>
> *-Ms. Chubrich, Junior English*









Quarter 1 Celebrations

CHAVEZ NAMED “ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT SCHOOL OF THE YEAR”

Cesar Chavez High School earned the 2023-2024 PXU Academic Achievement award for all large comprehensive schools. We are a school of opportunity. We will love your child and always put them first. We are truly raising CHAMPIONS in our community. Spread the word. We are building something special!

SENIOR SUCCESS AND AVID EXCELLENCE!

As of today, 100% of our seniors have been accepted into college and are working on building their scholarship packages with the help of College Depot. What an incredible resource for PXU! We’re also thrilled to announce that our AVID program has been recognized as a "Site of Distinction" for the second year in a row. We may be small, but we are mighty and continuing to grow! Congratulations to our amazing students and staff!

COLLABORATIVE TEAMS OF THE MONTH!

Congratulations to our Freshmen Biology and Junior English teachers for being nominated as our first "Collaborative Teams of the Month" for Quarter 1! Their unwavering commitment to collaboration and teamwork not only enhances their teaching practices but also significantly benefits our students’ learning experiences. Thank you for your hard work and inspiring efforts at Cesar Chavez High School!

ELD- CELEBRATING GROWTH IN MS. BOUMERZOUG'S CLASS!

We are incredibly proud of the progress Ms. Boumerzoug's ½ block class has made in their English language acquisition! Most of these students were newcomers with little to no English knowledge on their first day of school. Now, they are writing simple sentences, understanding sequencing, starting to form questions, and answering reading comprehension questions at their level. The class has come together as a true collaborative learning community, supporting one another and relying less on translators. This growth is definitely worth celebrating!

LAUNCH OF ACADEMIC CELEBRATION COMMITTEE

We are excited to announce the launch of our new Academic Celebration Committee at César Chávez High School! This committee is dedicated to recognizing and celebrating the hard work and achievements of our students throughout the year. As we kick off, you’ll see a slow roll-out of various awards designed to highlight student excellence across different academic areas. Stay tuned for more updates as we continue to celebrate the outstanding efforts of our Chávez scholars!

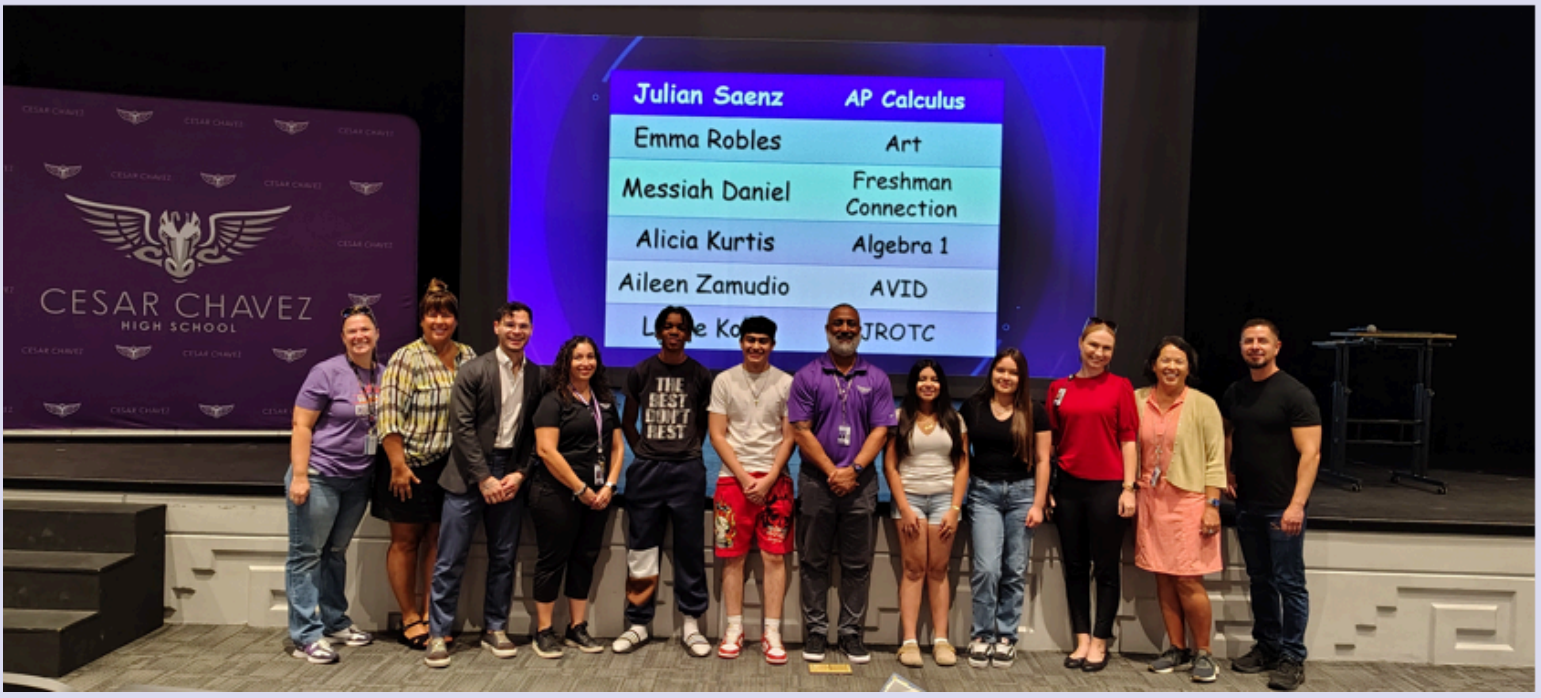
What Are Champion Learner Attributes?

Learner Attribute	Classroom	On Campus	Virtual Platforms
C Communication	•Use positive language. •Listen and be open to other different perspectives.	•Use appropriate and positive language.	•Use positive language. •Communicate technology concerns.
H Honor	•Demonstrate accountability for actions and learning. •Advocate for myself and others.	*Demonstrate accountability for actions and learning. *Keep areas clean. *Have ID visible.	*Maintain appropriate digital citizenship.
A Attentiveness	*Attend class daily and be on time. *Be prepared. *Use time effeciently and effectively.	*Be in assigned area. *Be on time.	*Have electronics ready. *Recognize technology concerns.
M Motivated	*Set goals and give your best effort. *Use the Advisory period and tutoring hours to meet your goals.	*Participate in: -Academic interventions -Support groups -Clubs & sports	*Stayfacused on scool-related websites. *Set goals and give your best effort.
P Problem Solve	Collaborate with staff and students. *Be flexible and adaptable to different situations.	*See something, say something. *Ask for help when necessary.	*See something, say something. *Ask for help when necessary.

Departments have started nominating one student each for the "Student of the Month" honor, selecting candidates within their content teams based on our criteria for what it means to be a CHAMP.



CHAMP Students of the Month



Congrats to: Julian Saenz (AP Calculus), Emma Robles (Art), Messiah Daniel (Freshman Connection), Alicia Kurtis (Algebra), Aileen Zamudio (AVID), and Leslie Kolb (JROTC)!

> I've always feel supported by my teachers, whether that be by academically challenging me or preparing me for college, they have always pushed me so that I can become a better student.
>
> *-Citlalli Garcia, Senior*







Department Highlights and Recognitions

CONGRATULATIONS TO OUR ALGEBRA 1-2 COLLABORATIVE TEAM!

We are excited to share that the Algebra 1-2 collaborative team scored above the district average on the District Common Assessment! This achievement reflects the hard work, dedication, and collaboration of our teachers and students. Their collective commitment to excellence in math education is truly commendable. Keep up the great work!

CELEBRATING OUR AMAZING WORLD LANGUAGES TEAM!

A heartfelt thank you from our World Language Instructional Leader, Mr. Alcantar, to Ms. Lizeth Encinas, Dr. Julie Monty, Mr. German Alvarez, Mrs. Abigail Griffin, Mrs. Roberta Laguna, Mr. Alfred Yazzie, Ms. Natalia Holmes, and Ms. Petra Schmid-Riggins. They are truly the best World Language teachers in all of PXU, and Cesar Chavez is incredibly fortunate to have each of them on our team! Your passion for teaching and dedication to your students' success are unmatched. We appreciate all that you do!

CULTURAL CELEBRATIONS AND LITERARY EXPLORATION IN ENGLISH LANGUAG ARTS

Our Mexican-American/Chicanx Perspectives course is celebrating cultural traditions by creating sugar skulls for Día de Muertos. Meanwhile, seniors in our CR African American Perspectives courses are hard at work writing essays for submission to the Phoenix Union Foundation Scholarships. Additionally, our freshmen have returned from break and are diving into literary analysis—starting with Edgar Allan Poe's stories, exploring literary elements, and soon moving into poetry analysis and writing. It's an exciting time of learning and creativity across our campus!

AVID (ADVANCEMENT VIA INDIVIDUAL DETERMINATION)

Our AVID Juniors and Seniors attended the "Be a Leader: Taking Steps Towards College Success Summit" at the Phoenix Convention Center on September 13th. They participated in sessions on college readiness, joined panels and discussions with expert speakers, and connected with ASU, U of A, NAU, GCU, and local community colleges at the Resource Fair.
On September 25th, some of our AVID students in grades 10-12 attended the Alpha Kappa Alpha Sorority, Incorporated Delta Beta Omega Chapter, and Phoenix Akarama Foundation's Annual HBCU College Fair. They engaged in workshops, learned about the rich history of HBCU schools, and explored information and resources available to them. Click here to view AVID's latest newsletter!

Student Artist Spotlights

CESAR CHAVEZ STUDENT ARTISTS SHINE!

We're thrilled to share that our talented student artists from Cesar Chavez were featured in the Phoenix Union District Board Room art display! Enjoy a few examples from our AP Studio Art class that were showcased during the month of September. Their creativity and dedication truly make us proud!









JAVIER CERVANTES

We are excited to share that Javier Cervantes, a student in Digital Photography 3-4, has been accepted by a high school media company called 480 Sports Media! Javier is actively pursuing his passion for photography and making valuable connections in the field he hopes to pursue after high school. A special thank you to his photo teacher, Ms. Ramirez for her support and his mom for her support in his creative journey, including purchasing equipment specifically for sports photography. Let's all congratulate Javier on this fantastic opportunity!

Advanced Placement (AP) Courses

WHAT IS ADVANCED PLACEMENT?

Did you know that taking Advanced Placement (AP) courses offers significant benefits for students? At César Chávez High School, we are proud to offer the most AP courses in PXU, providing students with college-level rigor while still in high school. AP courses can earn students college credit, saving time and money on tuition, and are weighted on a 5.0 scale, potentially boosting GPA. Colleges and scholarships favor students who take AP classes, as they show the ability to handle challenging material. AP courses also help students develop critical skills like time management and independent learning, preparing them for future success. Additionally, taking AP courses helps students stand out when applying to competitive and highly selective colleges, demonstrating their commitment to academic excellence and their readiness for advanced coursework.

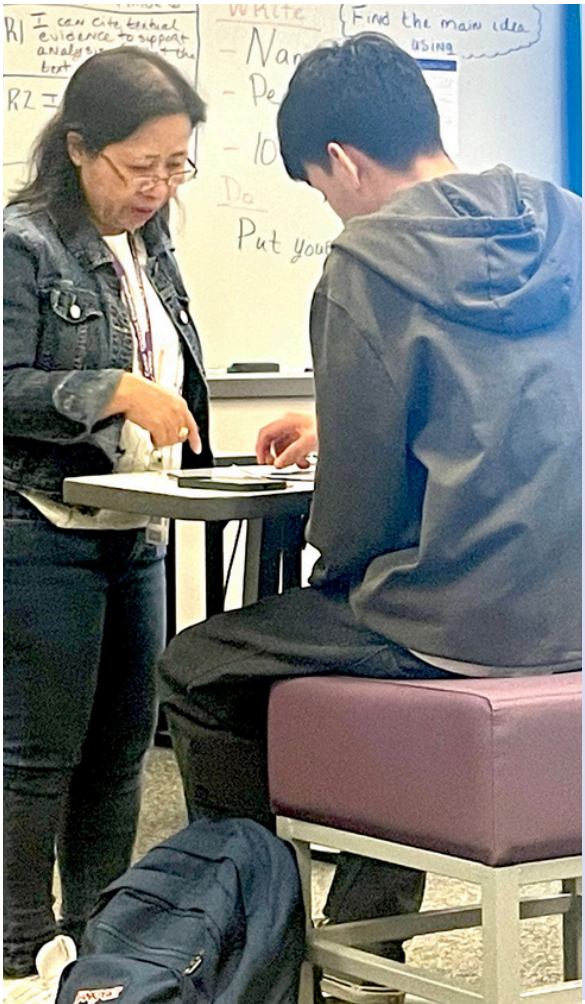
Students attending Chavez have the incredible opportunity to select from 15 different AP courses, and we are continuing to grow our AP program! This expansion allows our students to challenge themselves, develop their skills, and earn potential college credit while still in high school. We encourage all students to explore these options and take advantage of the rigorous academic experiences that AP courses offer.

Furthermore, we're excited to see our AP Spanish program expanding, and we want to encourage even more students to enroll next year! A big shoutout to Ms. Encinas for the incredible job she's done in promoting the program and inspiring students to take on the challenge of AP Spanish. If you're student is looking to elevate their Spanish skills and earn college credit, AP Spanish could be the perfect fit!

> "My AP teachers at Chavez are really good at challenging us. These classes have the ability to push and change you. I really enjoy the discussion-based activities in these classes."
>
> *-Chloe Flood, Senior*

> "Thanks to all the AP teachers who gave me guidance. They helped me navigate through the challenges of school and the real world with confidence."
>
> *-Johnny Rodriguez, Senior*





Dual Enrollment Courses

WHAT IS DUAL ENROLLMENT?

Dual Enrollment allows high school students to take college-level courses while earning both high school and college credits. This program gives students a head start on their college journey, potentially reducing the number of courses needed after high school and allowing for earlier graduation. It also helps students experience the rigor of college coursework, easing their transition into higher education.

Additionally, Dual Enrollment boosts college admission prospects and offers flexibility for students to explore other majors, study abroad, or pursue internships. Encouraging your student to participate in Dual Enrollment can provide valuable academic and financial benefits!

54 juniors are currently enrolled to earn dual credit for English 101 and 19 seniors are enrolled to earn English 102 credit! We have many students signed up for our MGT175 and LDR100 Dual Enrollment Courses for JROTC!

Encourage your student to speak with their counselor during our upcoming in-house registration!

Testing

The majority of our testing season takes place in the Spring. Below is a preview of the upcoming Spring testing dates:

February - March 2025 - AZELLA Testing
March 18 - Pre-ACT (10th Grade)
March 25- ACT (11th Grade)
April 1- AZ Science (11th Grade)
April 8- ACT Aspire (9th Grade)
May 5-16 - AP Testing (various subjects and grades)

NWEA ENGLISH AND MATH GROWTH ASSESSMENTS

NWEA testing is an important tool used in high schools to measure student growth and academic progress in subjects like math and reading. It helps teachers identify areas where students may need additional support, ensuring they receive the right resources to succeed. Encouraging your child to do their best on the NWEA test is crucial, as it provides valuable insight into their strengths and areas for improvement, helping guide their learning path and prepare them for future academic challenges. **Round II NWEA testing will occur during the first 2 weeks of December or immediately following our Winter Break**. Round III will occur during the last week of April.

ACT PREP

J**uniors will take the ACT on March 25th, 2025.** We are excited to announce the launch of our new ACT Prep Committee at César Chávez High School! This initiative aims to better prepare our students for the ACT exam in the spring. Our committee will provide online support during advisory classes, enhance teacher education and resources, and offer tutoring and workshops for students. We are excited host our first **Saturday ACT Prep workshop for Juniors on November 9th from 8am-12pm!**

> “We really try to center our conversations around where we want kids to be in the future and what we want them to be able to do, future being the end of the year or life. And with biology being the first science our students take on our campus, we want to give them high quality experiences so they can go out and do or tackle anything one day, including STEM related careers because they had a strong foundation here at Chavez.”
>
> *-Ms. Sanchez, 9th grade Biology*





Upcoming Events

October 24- PSAT/NMSQT Testing (11th grade)
October 25- Link Crew Tie Dye Event
October 30- Elective Fair
November 1st- December 13th - In-house course registration for 2025-2026 (students will meet with counselors during their science classes)
November 1- Students will follow a half-day early release schedule
November 4th-15th- Fall Food Drive, Click here- **Food Drive Flyer**
November 8th- Learning & Development Day Learning & Development Day: Students will be required to work from home, focusing on their math pathways in Edmentum, as part of their attendance requirements.
November 9th- Saturday ACT Prep Student Workshop for Juniors (8am-12pm
November 11- School Closed for Veteran’s Day
November 13th- JROTC Leadership & Academic Bowl
November 15th- Theatre Production “The Laramie Project” 6:30pm ($5 for students, $10 for adults. NOTE- This is a mature drama and may not be suitable for children)
November 15-16- PXU Academic Decathlon Scrimmage (at Maryvale High School)
November 19-21- ASAVB Testing (11th grade)
November 27th - Students will follow a half-day early release schedule
November 28-29 - Thanksgiving Recess
December 5- FAFSA Morning/Night Info Session
December 17, 18, and 19 - End of Semester Final Exams
December 20-January 3- Winter Recess





Important Information

SCHOOL PICTURES & YEARBOOKS

School Pictures are ready to view and purchase. Please log in to JostensPix.com and create an account using any email. You will need your student's ID# Here is the code you need to continue your transaction: FE307724. All orders ship directly to you. **Picture retake day is October 29th** for all grade levels. Students can go to the Rifle Range at any time during the day to take their photo for the Yearbook. Yearbooks are available for $65 and can be purchased in the bookstore for cash/credit/debit.

COLLEGE READINESS

ARCH (Advanced Readiness at Chavez High) is our specialized, application-based, micro-school within the larger campus, tailored for students who aspire to meet the rigorous requirements for competitive universities. Our ARCH mentors provide guidance to help students become standout candidates for admission to these prestigious institutions. For more information, please contact the micro-school leader, Mrs. Cami Wells, or visit our website: ARCH at Chavez High.

Please consider having your student attend workshops sponsored by the **College Depot**. There are many opportunities available for our students. College Financial Aid workshops, ACT/SAT Test Preparation, and scholarship opportunities - all free of charge AND they feed students who attend various workshops. The College Depot is located on the 2nd floor of the Burton Barr Library. Here is the link: College Depot (phoenixpubliclibrary.org)



ENCOURAGING A LOVE OF READING

All students should have an independent reading book for their English class. Please encourage your child to read for at least 20 minutes a day. Setting aside time to read a book of your own while they read theirs can be a great way to quiet your minds, escape the noise of the world, and come together as a family.

SENIORS

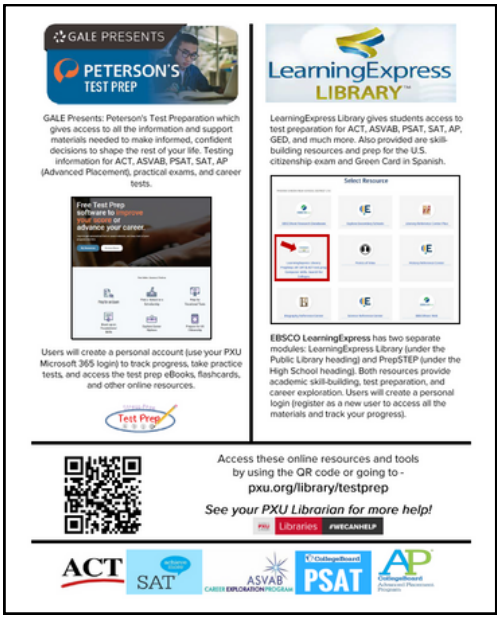
Completing the **FAFSA** is very important so that your student can be considered for financial aid. Please reach out to your student's counselor for more assistance. According to the website, the FAFSA will be open to most on December 1, 2024. Here is a link that may answer some of your questions. 2025–26 FAFSA® Form Coming Soon | Federal Student Aid

Graduation cap and gowns are available to order until October 31. Jostens is the sponsor for our district. Here is the direct link for Cesar Chavez packages, or feel free to itemize what is being offered to suit you and your graduate's needs. CESAR CHAVEZ HIGH SCHOOL LAVEEN, AZ - Graduation | Jostens



CCHS Library

TESTING SUPPORTS



“Work smarter, not harder!”

Click on this image to access the PXU Test Prep Databases.

RESOURCES AND TIPS

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HIGHLIGHTS



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